

1

The bridge, and the one rule

Q1 exported

Rs

2,09,98,210

→

corporate copies

less Rs

19,67,560

→

consumer copies

less Rs 30,650

→

clean = books

Rs

1,90,00,000

Rows: 201 in equals 186 kept plus 15 set aside. Rupees: Q1 as exported less the rupees set aside equals the books to the rupee.

Crux.

Reconcile twice, in rows and in rupees, to the books.

2

The pass, in order

Step	What it does	The failure it prevents
Profile	Present, convertible, distinct per field	A total from an unread file
Convert	Value or reason, failures logged	An order worth Rs 0
Identity rule	One row per order_id, the copy that validates	Copies in revenue
Keep, drop or flag	One decision per defect, with a reason	A guess that becomes a fact
Reconcile	Rows and rupees, to the books	A pass that rounds to right
Recompute	Every number already reported	A finding nobody rechecked

Crux.

Profile before you total: present, convertible, distinct, for every field.

3

Convert on purpose

```
def convert(value):
    try:
        return int(value), ""
    except (TypeError, ValueError):
        return None, "amount does not convert"
```

Everything read from a CSV is text: "900" < "1200" is False. A missing value is "" in a CSV and an absent key in JSON.

Crux.

A failure is logged, never turned into a number; large is not wrong.

4

Which copy stays

The pair	Keep	Log
Identical	The first	Second copy of the order
One amount unreadable	The copy that validates	Its twin carries the value
Valid, a field disagrees	The first extract	The field, and a question for the source

Choose the key before counting: whole record 0, record less line 13, order_id 15, a fuzzy match on customer and amount within 60 days, 15, with one real Rs 17,71,000 order among them.

Crux.

Say what makes two rows one order before you count duplicates.

5

Keep, drop or flag

Decision	Revenue	A status count	Use it when
Drop	Moves	Changes its denominator	The record is not an order
Default	Unchanged	Invents a value	A stated rule covers it
Keep and flag	Unchanged	Leaves it out	The value is unknown

A large order is a question about its record: a real Business order at Rs 29,45,460 stays, flagged, and Q2 is shown both ways. Repair a value only from a copy that could not share the error.

Crux.

Keep the copy that validates, and log every row you set aside.

6

The six wrong numbers of the day

The number	The step	The check
Largest Q2 order Rs 970	Sorting amounts as text	Below every Business order
0 duplicates	The file line in the key	201 rows, 186 order ids
188 orders, Q2 Rs 1,87,03,710	Record less line; Q1 tied, so stop	Rows against ids
201 of 201 convert, an order at Rs 0	Failures coerced to 0	The smallest real order is Rs 680
Q2 Rs 1,57,54,540, a 17.1% fall	The real bulk order fenced out	A known account, valid fields
201 = 185 + 16, Q1 Rs 1,89,98,210	Keep the first copy, then convert	Rs 1,790 short of the books

7

What changed downstream

Number	As Tuesday reported	On clean data
Revenue, Q1 to Q2	-11.0%	-1.6%
Retail-Plus orders per customer	-49.0%	-35.0%, 1.82 to 1.18

The finding stands, smaller.

Crux.

Recompute what you reported, and say what changed, the smaller number first.

THE WORDS ON THIS SHEET

- Profile

Three counts per field before any total: present, convertible, distinct
- Rejects log

Every row whose value failed, with its line, field and reason
- Identity rule

What makes two rows the same thing
- Keep and flag

Keep a record whose value is unknown, marked, out of counts that need it
- Coercion

Turning a value that fails into a default; a claim, never a fix
- Fence

A cut-off that marks a value to question, never to delete
- Control totals

A count and a sum computed at both ends of a transfer and compared
- Revenue bridge

One total walked to another, one move per cause